WAR CHESTS

With the conflict in West Asia completing its second week, it is pertinent to look at the enormous costs incurred by Israel, the US and Iran. Across platforms most used, here's how the cost war is playing out for the three



IRAN

$200 mn – $250 mn
Military cost per day

[Iran has fired over 3,000 missiles and drones towards Israel, US/ Gulf assets, ships]

KHORRAMSHAHR, FATTAH, SHAHAB-3, GHADR-1
Medium-range ballistic missiles
Cost per unit: $1-2 million

ZOLFAGHAR, TONDAR 69, QIAM-1, SHAHAB-1
Short-range ballistic missiles
Cost per unit: $500,000-1 million

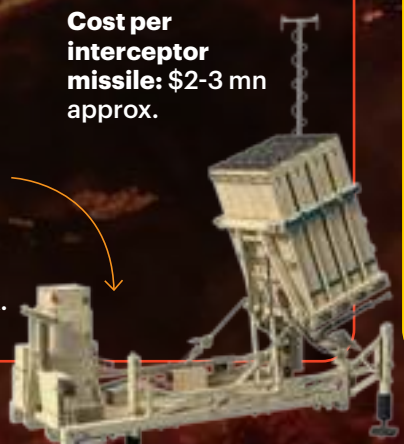
SOUMAR, HOVEYZEH, JK-2 ANTI-SHIP MISSILE
Submarine/ ground-launched cruise missiles
Cost per unit: $200,000-$500,000

SHAHED-136
One-way attack drone armed with 50 kg warhead
Cost per unit: $20,000-$50,000

AIR DEFENCE

IRON DOME
Anti-missile defence system made of short-range interceptor missiles for rockets/ drones
Cost per interceptor missile: $50,000 approx.

ARROW
Long-range anti-ballistic missile defence
Cost per interceptor missile: $2-3 mn approx.



THE COST-BENEFIT ASYMMETRY

Though Iranian missile/ drone launches have reduced in recent days, destroying a $20,000–$50,000 drone with a $3–4 million US/ Israeli interceptor missile is economically inefficient

IRAN		US / ISRAEL	
Cost of a Shahed drone	**$20,000–$50,000**	Cost of a Patriot interceptor missile	**$3-4 mn**
		Cost of a THAAD interceptor missile	**$15 mn+**
Cost of ballistic/ cruise missiles	**$0.5–$2 mn**	Cost of an Iron Dome interceptor missile	**$50,000**
		Cost of an Arrow interceptor missile	**$2-3 mn**

THE SOLUTION: Emulate Ukraine, which has developed low-cost counter-drone systems, including interceptor drones costing only a few thousand dollars, to counter Russian drone attacks, often using Iran-made machines